# Past simple: regular and irregular verbs

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

## Qué vas a aprender

- Talk about finished actions in the past (acciones terminadas)
- Add -ed to regular verbs with the right spelling
- Learn the most common irregular verbs
- Make negatives and questions with did / didn't

## Para pensar

**En español decimos «ayer jugué» y «ayer fui». En inglés, «jugué» es *played*, pero «fui» no es «goed». ¿Por qué?**

## Explicación

### What is the past simple?

We use the past simple for actions that **started and finished in the past**: «I **visited** my cousins last summer», «We **watched** a film yesterday». We often say **when** it happened.

**En castellano:** equivale a nuestro pretérito: «visité», «vimos». Una gran ventaja del inglés: el verbo **no cambia** según la persona. «I played», «you played», «he played», «they played». ¡No hay que memorizar seis terminaciones como en español!




### Regular verbs: -ed

Regular verbs add -ed: walk → walk**ed**, play → play**ed**, watch → watch**ed**, help → help**ed**.

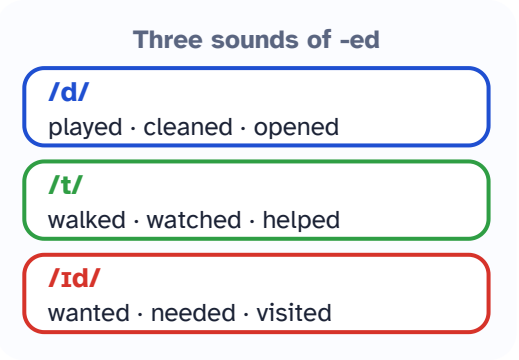
**Spelling rules:** verbs ending in -e add only **-d**: like → lik**ed**, dance → danc**ed**. Consonant + y changes to **-ied**: study → stud**ied**, cry → cr**ied** (but play → played, because a vowel comes before the y). Short verbs ending in consonant + vowel + consonant double the last letter: stop → sto**pp**ed, plan → pla**nn**ed.

| Verb | Past |
|---|---|
| **walk** | walked |
| **like** | liked |
| **study** | studied |
| **stop** | stopped |

## How do you say -ed?

The ending *-ed* has three sounds. After most sounds it is /d/: played, cleaned, opened. After sounds like p, k, s, sh, ch it is /t/: walked («wokt»), watched («wocht»), helped («helpt»).

After **t** or **d** it is a new syllable /ɪd/: wanted («uóntid»), needed («nídid»), visited. **En castellano:** casi nunca se pronuncia «-ed» completo; solo cuando el verbo acaba en t o d. Di en voz alta: «I **walked** to the park and I **wanted** an ice cream».




## Irregular verbs

Many common verbs are irregular: they don't add -ed. You need to learn them by heart (de memoria). Here are some of the most useful: go → **went**, have → **had**, eat → **ate**, see → **saw**, buy → **bought**, get → **got**, make → **made**, come → **came**, take → **took**, write → **wrote**, swim → **swam**, run → **ran**.

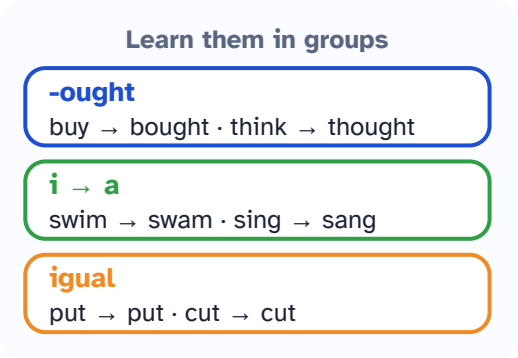
The verb **to be** has two forms: **was** (I, he, she, it) and **were** (you, we, they). «It **was** sunny», «We **were** at the beach».

| Verb | Past | Verb | Past |
|---|---|---|---|
| go | went | see | saw |
| have | had | buy | bought |
| eat | ate | make | made |
| come | came | write | wrote |

## Tricks to learn irregular verbs

Group them by sound and it's easier (agrúpalos por cómo suenan). **-ought / -aught:** buy → bought, bring → brought, think → thought, teach → taught. **i → a:** swim → swam, sing → sang, drink → drank, begin → began. **Same form:** put → put, cut → cut, hit → hit.

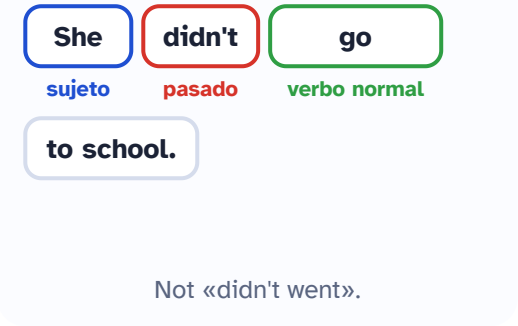
Make flashcards (tarjetas): the verb on one side, the past on the other. Practise five verbs a day. Sing them with a rhythm: «go, went – see, saw – eat, ate!». **En castellano:** no intentes aprender cien de golpe; los veinte más usados ya cubren casi todo.




## Negatives with didn't

To make a negative we use `didn't` (did not) + the verb in its **normal form**: «`I` **didn't play** football yesterday», «She **didn't go** to school». Careful: after *didn't* we never use the past: not «didn't went».

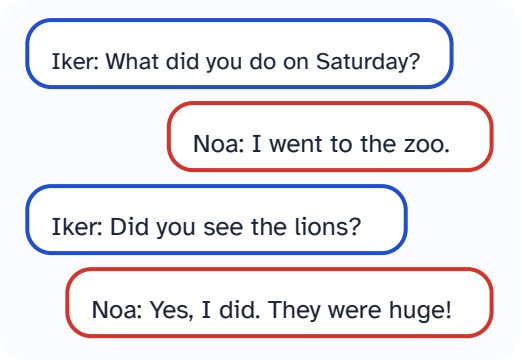
The verb **to be** is different: it doesn't need *didn't*. We say «`I` **wasn't** tired», «They **weren't** at home». **En castellano:** *did* ya lleva el pasado; por eso el verbo vuelve a su forma básica, igual que en el presente con *doesn't*.




## Questions with did

For questions we put Did at the beginning and the verb in its normal form: «**Did** you **enjoy** the trip?» – «Yes, I did. / No, I didn't». «**Did** he **see** the dolphins?» – «Yes, he did».

With question words: «**Where did** you go?», «**What did** you eat?», «**When did** they arrive?». With **to be**: «**Was** it fun?», «**Were** you scared?». Time words for the past: **yesterday, last night, last week, last summer, two days ago, in 2024**.




## Reading: my best holiday

Read Hugo's text: «Last summer I **went** to Asturias with my family. We **stayed** in a small house near the sea. On the first day it **rained**, so we **visited** a museum. Then the sun **came** out and we **swam** every day. I **tried** cheese from the mountains – it **was** delicious! We **didn't take** many photos, but I **wrote** a diary. It **was** the best holiday ever.»

Find six regular verbs and six irregular ones. Which verbs are in the negative?

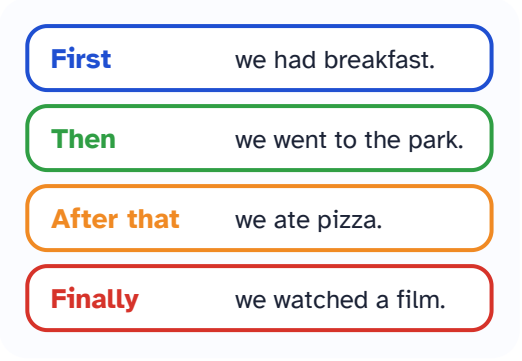



## Let's practise: guess my weekend

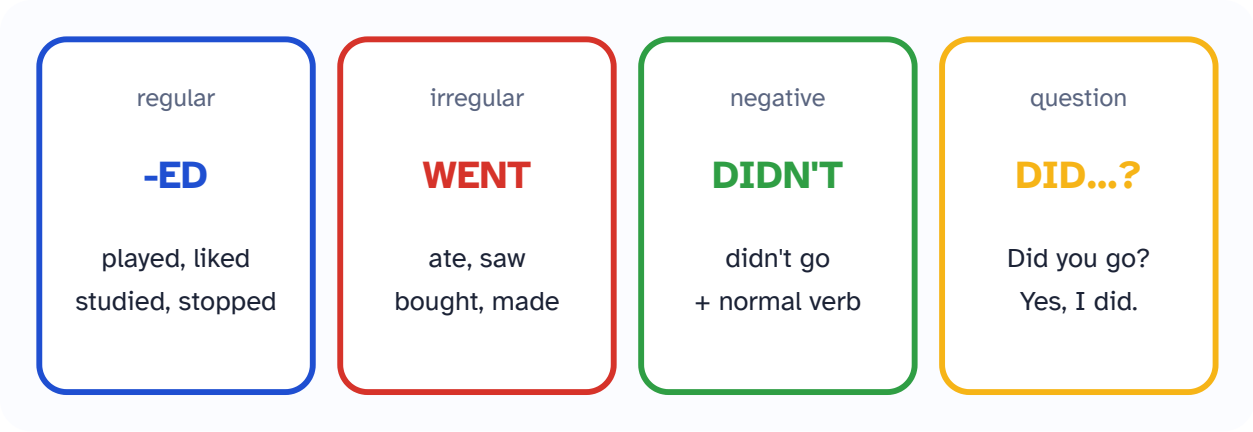
Play in groups. Write three sentences about last weekend: two true and one false (una falsa). «I **went** to the cinema. I **ate** sushi. I **played** tennis». Your classmates

ask questions to find the false one: «**Did you go** with your family?», «**What film did you see**?».

Then write a short text about a special day. Use time order words: **first, then, after that, finally**. **Consejo:** repasa al final si cada verbo está en pasado y si después de *did* has usado la forma normal.




## Past simple



## Ejercicios

1. **Write the past: play, like, cry, plan.**

2. **Write the past: go, eat, see, buy.**

3. **Complete with was or were: «The film ___ great. We ___ happy.»**

4. **Make it negative: «He wrote a letter.»**

5. **Make a question: «You had lunch at school.»**

6. **How do you pronounce -ed in «wanted», «watched», «played»?**

7. **Correct: «Yesterday I swimmed in the pool.»**

8. **Answer: «Did you watch TV last night?» (no)**

9. **Translate: «La semana pasada visitamos a mi abuela.»**

10. **Write three sentences about your last birthday.**

## Practica

1. **The past of «walk» is...**
   - **A)** walkt
   - **B)** walked
   - **C)** walk
2. **The past of «go» is...**
   - **A)** goed
   - **B)** gone
   - **C)** went
3. **The past of «study» is...**
   - **A)** studied
   - **B)** studyed
   - **C)** studed
4. **«___ you enjoy the party?»**
   - **A)** Do
   - **B)** Were
   - **C)** Did
5. **«She didn't ___ the bus.»**
   - **A)** took
   - **B)** take
   - **C)** takes
6. **«They ___ at the beach yesterday.»**
   - **A)** were
   - **B)** was
   - **C)** did
7. **The past of «eat» is...**
   - **A)** eated
   - **B)** ate
   - **C)** eaten
8. **Which is a past time expression?**
   - **A)** every day

**B)** now

**C)** two days ago

9. **The past of «stop» is...**

**A)** stopped

**B)** stoped

**C)** stopt

10. **In «wanted», -ed sounds...**

**A)** /t/

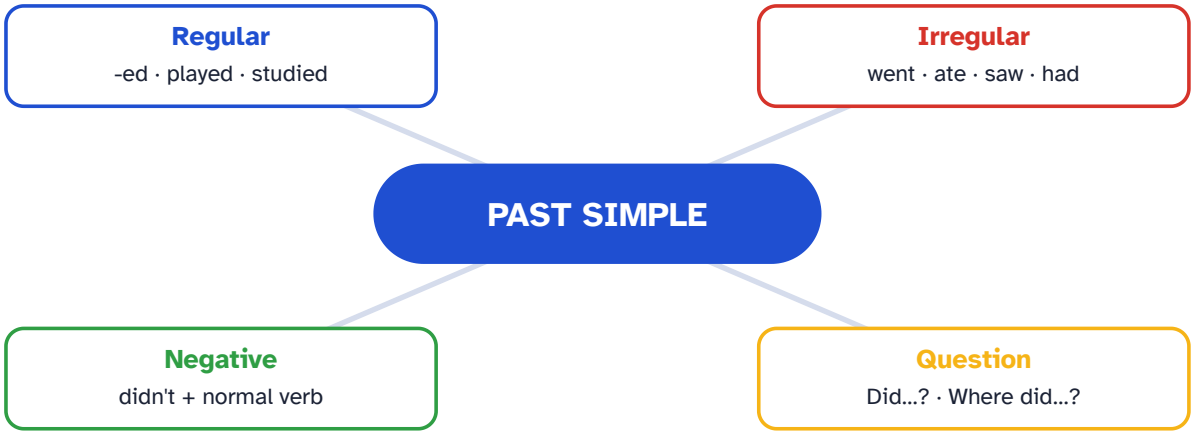
**B)** /ɪd/

**C)** /d/

## Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Para qué sirve el pasado simple; Cómo se forma el pasado de los verbos regulares y su ortografía; Qué son los verbos irregulares y algunos ejemplos; Cómo se hacen negativas y preguntas con did.

## Resumen




## Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

**Past simple**

Acciones terminadas en el pasado.

**-ed**

Pasado regular: walked, played.

**-ied / doble consonante**

studied · stopped.

**go → went**

Irregular muy frecuente.

**was / were**

Pasado de to be.

**didn't + verbo**

Negativa: I didn't go.

**Did...?**

Pregunta: Did you see it?

**ago**

Hace: two days ago = hace dos días.

## Soluciones

1. **B)** Regular: + -ed.
2. **C)** Irregular.
3. **A)** Consonante + y → -ied.
4. **C)** Pregunta en pasado: Did.
5. **B)** Tras didn't, forma normal.
6. **A)** They + were.
7. **B)** Irregular.
8. **C)** Ago = hace.
9. **A)** Se dobla la p.
10. **B)** Tras t o d, sílaba nueva.

## Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. played, liked, cried, planned.
2. went, ate, saw, bought.
3. was, were.
4. He didn't write a letter.
5. Did you have lunch at school?
6. /ɪd/, /t/, /d/.
7. Yesterday I swam in the pool.
8. No, I didn't.
9. Last week we visited my grandma.
10. Model answer: I had a party. My friends came to my house. We ate a chocolate cake.